

Station Host Protocol

A guide for station hosts facilitating a World Café. Following it consistently is what lets us treat the harvested results as data in a scientific study.

// YOUR ROLE

As a station host, you will act as host for this station throughout the World Café. Your role is to ensure an open, respectful debate around your station's topic. To achieve this:

- 1 Create a welcoming space.**
Set an easy, hospitable tone so people feel safe to think out loud.
- 2 Ensure everyone can contribute.**
Make room for quieter voices; don't let any one person dominate.
- 3 Listen to understand.**
Listen for meaning rather than waiting to reply or to correct.
- 4 Help the group identify patterns and themes.**
Reflect back connections between contributions and invite the group to name them.
- 5 Remain objective and neutral.**
Keep your own views out of it; treat every position even-handedly.
- 6 Facilitate, don't steer.**
Open up the conversation with questions; never nudge it toward a preferred answer.
- 7 Harvest collective discoveries on the sheet.**
Capture the group's insights in their words, on the station sheet, as they emerge.

// WHY THIS MATTERS

Every station is hosted the same way so that differences in the results reflect the conversations, not the hosts. Your neutrality and consistent harvesting are what make the material comparable across stations and usable as research data.